

don't create a taxable event, calling it a death tax is mathematically nonsensical.

Boo-hoo if your estate owes taxes on everything over \$27 million. First, it means you had more money than you knew what to do with. And second, as I discuss in later chapters, if you had done a little bit of planning, you wouldn't even need to pay that.

Why would someone use the phrase "death tax" when more than 99% of deaths don't result in a tax? Always ask yourself, "What are they selling?" Someone is deceiving you in their attempts at persuasion.



Since we are already discussing death, let's look at an especially silly example of denominator blindness.

¹²⁸ Gus Lubin, "49 Former NASA Scientists Send A Letter Disputing Climate Change," *Business Insider* (April 11, 2012).

¹²⁹ Ihor Gawdiak with Helen Fedor, *NASA Historical Data Book, Volume IV* (NASA Resources, 1969–1978).

¹³⁰ US Bureau of Labor Statistics, Employment Situation Summary, bls.gov.

¹³¹ Sam Ro, "Mind the anecdotal," taker.co (January 22, 2023). See also: Sam Ro, "Don't be misled by no-context reports of big tech layoffs," taker.co (November 15, 2022).

¹³² Justin Aquino, "From Estate Tax to Death Tax: How to Change Public Opinion Overnight," coolcommunicator.com.

¹³³ In 2021, there were 3,464,231 deaths—up substantially from 2019 levels pre-Covid of 2,854,838. That fell to 3.27 million deaths in 2022, and have continued falling since. I am rounding down to only 3 million (but it could be more). National Vital Statistics Reports Volume 70, Number 8, "Deaths: Final Data for 2019," cdc.gov (July 26, 2021). See also: National Center for Health Statistics, "Deaths and Mortality," cdc.gov.